ME 5309 – Mid-Semester Examination: ANSWER SHEET

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Questions attempted: Q1, Q4

Question 1

Given: sensor 1280 px wide, pixel pitch p = 5 µm (square), lens f = 16 mm, standoff Z = 400 mm; force sensor 10 mV/N, 12-bit ADC over 0–5 V; plant $\dot{x} = -2x + u$ with zero-order hold, T = 0.1 s.

(a) Assumptions: pinhole (thin-lens) camera model, lens focused on the belt plane, belt plane perpendicular to the optical axis, no lens distortion, so every pixel images the same length on the belt.

(i) The focal length in pixel units is the physical focal length divided by the pixel pitch: $f_x = f/p = (16\times10^{-3}\text{ m})/(5\times10^{-6}\text{ m}) = 3200$. The metres cancel so the answer is in pixels. **f_x = 3200 px**.

(ii) Width of the sensor = N·p = 1280 × 5 µm = 6400 µm = 6.4 mm. Using similar triangles between the sensor and the belt plane, $W_s/f = FOV/Z$, hence $FOV = W_s \cdot Z/f = (6.4\text{ mm})(400\text{ mm})/(16\text{ mm}) = 160$ mm. **FOV = 160 mm**.

Ground sampling distance = FOV/N = 160 mm / 1280 px = 0.125 mm/px. Cross-chek with the pixel-based formula Z/f_x = 400 mm / 3200 px = 0.125 mm/px; both agree, so **1 pixel = 0.125 mm = 125 µm** on the belt.

(b) Assumptions: ideal 12-bit ADC (4096 codes), the full 0–5 V range is used, no offset or gain error, and sensor noise is below one LSB so quantisation sets the limit.

Voltage step: 1 LSB = $V_{FS}/2^N = 5\text{ V}/4096 = 1.2207\times10^{-3}$ V = 1.2207 mV.

The sensor maps force to voltage by V = S·F with S = 10 mV/N, so $\Delta F_{min} = \Delta V/S$ = 1.2207 mV / (10 mV/N) = 0.12207 N. **$\Delta F_{min} \approx 0.122$ N**. (Using 4095 steps instead of 4096 codes gives 0.1221 N, the same at 3 s.f.)

(c) $F = e^{AT}$, $G = A^{-1}(F - I)B$. Taking T = 0.01 s.

$F = e^{-0.02} =$ **0.9802**.

$G = (0.9802 - 1)/(-2) =$ **0.0099**.

Question 4

Given: plant $\ddot{\theta} + a\dot{\theta} + c\theta = b\,u$ with a = 2, c = 6, b = 1; controller $u = N_{ff}\,r - k_1\theta - k_2\dot{\theta}$.

(a) Substitute the control law into the plant: $\ddot{\theta} + a\dot{\theta} + c\theta = b\,N_{ff}\,r - b\,k_1\,\theta - b\,k_2\,\dot{\theta}$. Moving the feedback terms to the left: $\ddot{\theta} + (a + b\,k_2)\,\dot{\theta} + (c + b\,k_1)\,\theta = b\,N_{ff}\,r$.

Numerically, $a + b\,k_2 = 2 + 2 = 4$ and $c + b\,k_1 = 6 + 2 = 8$, so the characteristic equation is $s^2 + 4s + 8 = 0$. Roots: $s = [-4 \pm \sqrt{(16 - 32)}]/2 = -2 \pm 2j$. They have negative real parts, so the loop is stable; $\omega_n = \sqrt{8} = 2.83$ rad/s and $\zeta = 4/(2 \times 2.83) = 0.707$.

Transfer function from r to θ: $T(s) = b\,N_{ff} / (s^2 + 4s + 8)$. DC gain (s = 0): $T(0) = N_{ff}/8$. For unitiy DC gain, **N_{ff} = 8**. (Note that this is larger than 1 because the graviy-related stiffness c and the feedback k_1 both resist the displacement.)

(b) $G_{DC} = bN_{ff}/(c + bk_1) = 6/7.5 = 0.8$, so $\theta_{ss} =$ **0.8**.

Percentage error = 0.8 × 100 = **80%**.

(c) Take the state $z = [\theta, \dot{\theta}, \xi]^T$. The plant gives $\ddot{\theta} = -a\dot{\theta} - c\theta + b\,u$ with $u = -k_1\theta - k_2\dot{\theta} + K_I\xi$, and $\dot{\xi} = r - \theta$. With r = 0 (r only shifts the equilibrium) the closed-loop matrix is $A_{cl} = [0, 1, 0; -(c + bk_1), -(a + bk_2), bK_I; -1, 0, 0]$.

Characteristic polynomial $\det(sI - A_{cl})$, expanding along the first row: $s\cdot[(s + a + bk_2)s - 0] + 1\cdot[(c + bk_1)s + bK_I] = s^3 + (a + bk_2)s^2 + (c + bk_1)s + bK_I$. **(Reuslt)**

Desiered poles -4 and $-2 \pm 2j$: $(s + 2 - 2j)(s + 2 + 2j) = (s + 2)^2 + 4 = s^2 + 4s + 8$. Multiply by $(s + 4)$: $s^3 + 4s^2 + 8s + 4s^2 + 16s + 32 = s^3 + 8s^2 + 24s + 32$.

Compare coefficients with $a = 2$, $b = 1$, $c = 6$: s^2: $2 + k_2 = 8 \Rightarrow \mathbf{k_2 = 6}$. s^1: $6 + k_1 = 24 \Rightarrow \mathbf{k_1 = 18}$. s^0: $b K_I = 32 \Rightarrow \mathbf{K_I = 32}$.

Check: all coefficients of the desired polynomial are positive and $(8)(24) = 192 > 32$, so Routh–Hurwitz confirms the three poles are in the left half plane ✓.

(d) Steady state: $\dot{\xi} = 0$, so $r = \theta_{ss}$; the parameters b and c do not enter, hence zero error for any b and c as long as it is stable.

Failure mode: windup when the acuator saturtes. Remedy: reduce K_I to zero (or use a smaller gain) while saturated.